

Lean Waste Lens (AI)

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Eliminating the eight wastes with AI

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Lean Waste Lens applies the classic categories of waste (the eight 'mudas') to identify where AI can eliminate non-value-adding activity such as overprocessing, waiting, defects and unused talent.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Built on the Toyota Production System and Lean thinking codified by Ohno, Womack and Jones, extended to AI-enabled operations.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to direct improvement effort at systematic categories of waste rather than ad hoc fixes.

FIGURE 1 · LEAN WASTE LENS (AI)



Figure 1. A schematic of the Lean Waste Lens (AI) as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Each waste category is examined for AI remedies; AI is deployed where it removes waste rather than merely accelerating it.

WHEN IT IS USED

During operational improvement and AI use-case identification in processes.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Operations, quality and continuous-improvement teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It channels AI toward proven waste categories, guarding against automating waste instead of eliminating it.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Cost-to-Serve Curve · Slibrary 7

Process Cycle Efficiency · Slibrary 7

Throughput Accounting · Slibrary 7

Effort-Value Reallocation · Slibrary 7

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Ohno, T. (1988) Toyota Production System. Cambridge: Productivity Press.

Womack, J.P. and Jones, D.T. (1996) Lean Thinking. New York: Simon & Schuster.